

The Language of Love (& Disaster)

**Valentine's Day
Vocabulary in Action**



Three Valentine's Day Scenarios

1

The Setup & The Blind Date (Joey & Chandler)

Unexpected pairing. Awkward introductions. Comedic misunderstandings. High energy.

2

The Ex-Wife Encounter (Ross & Carol)

Unresolved feelings. Tense interactions. Emotional turbulence. Sizzling drama.

3

The Breakup Ritual (Monica, Rachel & Phoebe)

Supportive gathering. Symbolic release. Cleansing process. Smoky catharsis.



THE DATING GLOSSARY

BLIND DATE (n):

A date with someone you have never met before.
(Chandler has no idea who he is meeting).

DOUBLE DATE (n):

Two couples going out together.
(Joey brings Chandler so he can date Lorraine).

TO ROPE IN (phrasal verb):

To persuade someone to do something they don't want to do.
(Joey ropes Chandler into the disastrous evening).



Idiom Spotlight: To Backfire

Definition

When a plan has the exact opposite result of what you wanted.

In Context

Joey's plan to have a fun double date backfires when Chandler's blind date turns out to be Janice, his clingy ex-girlfriend!



Action Words: Escaping a Date

To Ditch someone:

To leave a person without warning.
(Joey ditched Chandler).

To Run off:

To leave quickly to go somewhere else.
(Joey ran off with Lorraine).

To Abandon:

To leave someone alone when they need you.
(Joey abandons Chandler, leaving him with the bill).

A kitchen scene featuring a stainless steel griddle with a large flame rising from a piece of bread cooking on it. Several empty white plates are arranged around the griddle. The background shows a dimly lit restaurant interior with warm lighting.

The Uncomfortable Reunion

To Strike Out (v):
To fail at something,
especially dating.
(Ross struck out on his
first date in 9 years).

Delusional (adj):
Believing something that
is completely untrue.
(Ross is wildly delusional
to think he can fix his
marriage).

To Reminisce (v):
To happily talk about the
past. (Ross and Carol
reminisce about old
times).

Cultural Concept: The Third Wheel

Meaning: A person who feels uncomfortable because they are the extra, unwanted person hanging out with a couple.

The Situation:

Ross pays so much attention to his ex-wife Carol that his actual date, Kristen, becomes a third wheel.

The Result:

Kristen literally leaves the restaurant, and Ross doesn't even notice!





How to say “No”

To Let (someone) Down (phrasal verb):

To disappoint someone, usually by rejecting them romantically.

Gently (adv):

Doing something in a kind, soft, and careful way.

In Context: Carol tells Ross that the right person is out there for him. She firmly closes the door on their marriage, but she lets him down gently.

The Breakup Bonfire

A photograph of a bonfire in a metal bucket. Sparks are flying from the fire. Three items are being thrown into the fire: a Polaroid photo of a couple, a piece of paper with handwritten text, and a pair of plaid boxer shorts.

Mementos (n): Objects kept as a reminder of a person or a past event. (Letters, photos, receipts).

Ritual (n): A ceremony or action performed in a specific, repetitive way.

To Cleanse (v):
To make something totally clean or to remove bad energy. (The girls want to cleanse their bad luck in love).

Emergency Phrasal Verbs

To Go Up: To quickly catch fire.
(Paolo's pure alcohol made the bonfire go up).

To Show Up: To arrive at a place.
(The fire department showed up).

To Put Out: To stop a fire from burning.
(The three firefighters put out the flames).



Idiom Spotlight: Tempting Fate

Definition

Doing something risky that causes your good luck to turn into bad luck.

In Context

The girls think the handsome firefighters are a “Valentine’s Miracle.” But the men secretly have wives!

Result

The universe immediately takes it back.



The On-Again, Off-Again Ex



CHAN
& JAN
FOREVER

To Seek Out (v):
To look for someone intentionally.
(Janice realizes Chandler keeps seeking her out).

To Dump someone (v):
To end a romantic relationship.
(Chandler has dumped her twice in just 5 months)

To Keep Score (v):
To mentally track who is winning or losing in a relationship.

Review: Anatomy of a Dating Disaster

The Situation

The Blind Date

The Ex-Wife

The Single Life

The Mistake

The Double Date
Backfires

Treating the date like
a Third Wheel

The cleansing ritual
goes up in flames

Vocab Used

To ditch,
To run off,
Blind Date

Delusional,
To reminisce,
Let down gently

Memento,
To put out,
Tempt fate



The Joey Philosophy

"Peak [Name]" (slang):

A perfect example of a person's typical, predictable behavior.

Zero Guilt, Maximum Reward:

Getting everything you want without feeling bad about how you got it.

Example: Ditching your friend on a blind date so you can hook up with someone else? That is absolutely Peak Joey.

Class Dismissed!

*You've survived the
Valentine's Day chaos.*



**Which dating disaster
vocabulary will you use next?**

OPEN